

SWITCH

1. Passage anchor

> “It was like a light **switching on** in a dim room.”

Passage meaning

switch on = make an electrical device or light start operating

打開；開啟（電器、燈等）

In the passage, this is part of a metaphor:

a light switching on

→ suddenly seeing or understanding something clearly

像燈突然亮起一樣，猛然明白了

Practice

1. She **switched on the light** and opened the curtains.
她**打開燈**，然後拉開窗簾。
2. His explanation made something **switch on in my mind**.
他的解釋讓我腦中像是**突然亮了一盞燈**。

Core meanings of SWITCH

2. switch — noun: a device used to turn something on or off

= a small control used to start, stop, or change the operation of an electrical device

開關

Examples

1. Where is the light **switch**?
電燈**開關**在哪裡？
2. Flip the **switch** to turn the machine on.
撥動**開關**來啟動機器。

Common:

* light switch 電燈開關

* power switch 電源開關

* wall switch 牆上開關

3. switch on

= make a device, light, machine, etc. begin operating

打開；開啟

Examples

1. Please **switch on the fan**.

請**打開風扇**。

2. He **switched on the computer**.

他**開啟了電腦**。

Especially common in British English.

In American English, **turn on** is often more common in everyday speech.

4. switch off

= make a device, light, machine, etc. stop operating

關掉；關閉

Examples

1. Don't forget to **switch off the lights**.

別忘了**關燈**。

2. She **switched off the television**.

她**關掉了電視**。

Opposite of **switch on**.

Changing from one thing to another

5. switch — verb: change from one thing to another

= stop using, doing, or choosing one thing and begin using, doing, or choosing another

轉換；改換；改用

Examples

1. We **switched to a different system** last year.
我們去年**改用了另一套系統**。

2. She **switched from coffee to tea**.
她從喝咖啡**改成喝茶**。

This is one of the most important meanings.

6. switch from A to B

= change from one option, system, activity, or state to another
從A轉換到B

Examples

1. The company **switched from paper records to digital files**.
公司從紙本紀錄**轉成數位檔案**。

2. He **switched from engineering to design**.
他從工程領域**轉到設計領域**。

7. switch to something

= begin using or doing a different thing
改用；轉用；轉向

Examples

1. Many people have **switched to electric cars**.
很多人已經**改開電動車**。

2. We decided to **switch to a cheaper plan**.
我們決定**改用較便宜的方案**。

8. switch between A and B

= alternate repeatedly between two things

****在A與B之間切換****

Examples

1. She can easily ****switch between English and Chinese****.
她可以輕鬆地****在英文和中文之間切換****。
2. The app lets you ****switch between different views****.
這個應用程式讓你可以****切換不同顯示模式****。

Exchanging places or roles

9. switch places

= exchange positions with another person

****交換位置；換位子****

Examples

1. Can we ****switch places****?
我們可以****交換位置****嗎？
2. The two students ****switched places****.
兩名學生****換了座位****。

10. switch roles

= exchange functions, responsibilities, or positions

****交換角色；互換職責****

Examples

1. Halfway through the exercise, the students ****switched roles****.
練習做到一半時，學生們****交換角色****。
2. The parents ****switched roles**** for the day.
這對父母那天****互換了分工****。

11. switch sides

A. move physically from one side to another

****換邊****

B. change support, allegiance, or position

****轉換立場；倒向另一方****

Examples

1. The teams ****switched sides**** after the break.

休息後兩隊****交換場地****。

2. Several members later ****switched sides****.

幾名成員後來****改變了立場****。

Changing channels, modes, settings

12. switch channels

= change from one television or radio channel to another

****轉台；換頻道****

Examples

1. Can you ****switch channels****?

你可以****轉台****嗎？

2. He kept ****switching channels**** during the news.

新聞播出時他一直****換台****。

13. switch modes

= move from one operating mode to another

****切換模式****

Examples

1. The camera automatically ****switches modes**** in low light.

相機在低光環境下會自動****切換模式****。

2. You can ****switch to dark mode**** in the settings.

你可以在設定中**切換到深色模式**。

14. switch accounts / profiles

= move from one account or user profile to another

切換帳號 / 使用者設定檔

Examples

1. I need to **switch accounts**.

我需要**切換帳號**。

2. You can quickly **switch between profiles**.

你可以快速**切換不同設定檔**。

Changing attention, topic, or mental focus

15. switch attention / focus

= redirect attention from one thing to another

轉移注意力 ; 切換焦點

Examples

1. It was difficult to **switch my attention** back to work.

我很難把**注意力轉回工作**。

2. The discussion **switched focus** to costs.

討論的**焦點轉向**成本。

16. switch topics / subjects

= begin discussing something different

轉換話題

Examples

1. She quickly **switched topics**.

她很快就**換了話題**。

2. Let's **switch** to another subject.

我們**換個話題**吧。

Sudden mental shift

17. something switches on in your mind

= begin functioning or become suddenly clear mentally

腦中突然開竅；突然明白

This is a figurative extension of the electrical meaning.

Examples

1. Suddenly, something **switched on** in my brain and I understood the pattern.

突然間，我腦中像是**開竅了**，理解了那個規律。

2. Her question seemed to **switch something on** in him.

她的問題似乎讓他**突然領悟到什麼**。

This is especially relevant to the passage metaphor.

Noun: a change

18. switch — noun: a change from one thing to another

= an act of changing from one option, system, position, or activity to another

轉換；改變；改換

Examples

1. The **switch to online learning** happened quickly.

轉向線上學習發生得很快。

2. The company announced a **switch in strategy**.

公司宣布了**策略上的轉變**。

19. make a switch

= make a deliberate change to another option

****作出轉換；改換****

Examples

1. We decided to ****make the switch**** to renewable energy.
我們決定****轉用再生能源****。
2. She finally ****made the switch**** to a new career.
她終於****轉換了職業跑道****。

Computing and networks

20. switch — network switch

= a device that connects devices within a computer network and directs data to the appropriate destination

****網路交換器****

Examples

1. The computers are connected through a network ****switch****.
這些電腦透過網路****交換器****連接。
2. The technician replaced the faulty ****switch****.
技術人員更換了故障的網路****交換器****。

This is a distinct technical noun sense.

21. switch — electronic switching component

= a component that opens, closes, or redirects an electrical or electronic circuit

****開關元件；切換元件****

Examples

1. The circuit uses an electronic ****switch****.
這個電路使用電子****開關元件****。
2. The ****switch**** controls the flow of current.
這個****開關****控制電流。

Technical but established.

Railways

22. switch — railway points / track mechanism

In North American English:

= a mechanism that moves trains from one track to another

****鐵路轉轍器；道岔****

Examples

1. The train moved through the ****switch**** onto another track.

火車經過****轉轍器****駛入另一條軌道。

2. A faulty ****switch**** delayed several trains.

一個故障的****轉轍器****造成多班列車延誤。

British English commonly uses ****points**** for this sense.

Physical switching/exchange

23. switch something with something

= exchange one thing for another

****交換；調換****

Examples

1. Someone ****switched**** my bag with theirs by mistake.

有人不小心把我的包和他的****拿錯交換了****。

2. The labels had been ****switched****.

標籤被****對調了****。

24. switch two things around

= exchange their positions or order

****對調；把位置互換****

Examples

1. I accidentally **switched the two names around**.
我不小心把兩個名字**對調了**。

2. Let's **switch the chairs around**.
我們把椅子的位置**換一下**。

Informal behavioral change

25. switch from one mood/style to another

= change suddenly in manner, tone, or behavior
突然轉變；切換

Examples

1. He can **switch from serious to playful** very quickly.
他可以很快從嚴肅**轉成輕鬆玩鬧**。

2. Her tone suddenly **switched**.
她的語氣突然**變了**。

Common phrasal uses

26. switch off — stop paying attention

Informally:

= lose interest or stop mentally paying attention
失去興趣；不再專心

Examples

1. I **switch off** when meetings become too long.
會議太長時，我就會開始**走神**。

2. Half the class seemed to **switch off** during the lecture.
課程進行到一半時，班上一半的人似乎都**不再專心**。

This is a figurative extension of turning a machine off.

27. switch someone off

= make someone lose interest or enthusiasm

****讓某人失去興趣；倒胃口****

Examples

1. Too much technical language ****switches people off****.

太多技術性用語會讓人****失去興趣****。

2. His arrogant manner really ****switched me off****.

他傲慢的態度真的讓我****很反感****。

Informal.

28. switch on — become mentally alert or engaged

Less fixed than the device meaning, but figuratively:

= become alert, engaged, or mentally active

****開始專注；腦筋開始運轉****

Examples

1. It takes me a while to ****switch on**** in the morning.

我早上需要一點時間才能****清醒進入狀態****。

2. Once the discussion became interesting, everyone ****switched on****.

討論變得有趣後，大家都開始****專注起來****。

Related forms

29. switching

= the act or process of changing from one thing, state, route, or setting to another

****切換；轉換****

Examples

1. ****Switching between tasks**** can reduce concentration.

不斷**切換任務**可能降低專注力。

2. The system allows automatic **switching** between networks.

這套系統可以在不同網路之間自動**切換**。

30. switchable

= capable of being switched between states or modes

可切換的

Examples

1. The device has **switchable modes**.

這個裝置有**可切換模式**。

2. The lens has **switchable settings**.

這個鏡頭有**可切換的設定**。

Lower-frequency technical adjective.

Key contrasts

31. switch vs change

change is broader.

It can mean:

* become different

* make something different

* replace

* develop

switch more strongly suggests:

stop using/doing one thing and move to another identifiable alternative

Compare:

> She **changed** her hairstyle**.

> 她改變了髮型。

The hairstyle itself became different.

> She **switched** to a different hairdresser.

> 她改去找另一位髮型師。

One option was replaced by another.

32. switch vs replace

switch

= move from one choice or item to another

轉換；換用

replace

= remove something and put another thing in its place

替換

Compare:

> We **switched to** a new system.

> 我們**改用**新系統。

> We **replaced** the old system.

> 我們**替換了**舊系統。

The perspectives differ.

33. switch vs turn on/off

For electrical devices:

switch on / off

開啟 / 關閉

turn on / off

also **開啟 / 關閉**

Both are standard.

Broad tendency:

* **switch on/off** is especially common in British English.

* **turn on/off** is extremely common in North American English and widely used elsewhere.

34. switch vs swap

switch

= change positions/options or move from one to another

swap

= exchange one thing directly for another

交換

Compare:

> Let's **switch seats**.

> 我們換位子吧。

> Let's **swap seats**.

> 我們交換座位吧。

Both are natural here.

But:

> **switch to** another provider ✓

> **swap to** another provider is much less standard in general English.

35. switch vs shift

switch

often implies movement between distinct alternatives.

shift

often implies a change in position, emphasis, direction, or degree.

Compare:

> We **switched from** Windows to Linux.

> 我們從 Windows **改用** Linux。

> Public attention **shifted toward** the economy.

> 公眾注意力**轉向**經濟問題。

Meaning map

The central concept of **switch** is:

change a connection, position, or active option

From this develop several branches:

Electrical control

switch

→ switch on / switch off

→ **開關；開啟 / 關閉**

Choice

switch from A to B

→ **轉換；改用**

Position

switch places

→ **交換位置**

Setting

switch channels / modes

→ **切換**

Mental attention

switch focus / switch off mentally

→ **轉移注意 / 走神**

Networks and railways

network switch / railway switch

→ **交換器 / 轉轍器**

The common thread is not simply “change,” but **moving a system, connection, role, or choice from one state/path to another**.

Passage recap

> “It was like a light **switching on** in a dim room.”

Literally:

switch on a light

= **開燈**

But the passage uses the image metaphorically:

dark/dim room

→ lack of clarity

light switches on

→ sudden clarity

So the whole image means:

那一刻我像突然開竅了一樣，一切變得清楚。

MCQ-ready meaning

switch on in the passage image

= **cause a light or electrical device to begin operating**

打開；開啟

Its figurative effect in context is:

suddenly understand or see something clearly

突然明白；豁然開朗